Are Your Children Equipped For The Journey?

DAVID FUGEL LIFE SHERPA

SOME AWFUL STATISTICS ON COLLEGE STUDENT MENTAL HEALTH

More than 65% percent of college students struggled with anxiety, depression and overwhelm on campus.

28.6% OF COLLEGE STUDENTS REPORT BEING SO DEPRESSED "IT'S DIFFICULT TO FUNCTION."

NATIONAL COLLEGE HEALTH ASSESSMENT

47.1% OF COLLEGE STUDENTS SAY THEY EXPERIENCE "OVERWHELMING ANXIETY"

NATIONAL COLLEGE HEALTH ASSESSMENT (2009)

LET'S START TO SOLVE THIS EPIDEMIC AT THE BEGINNING!

Medical Daily

High School Students Are Stressed Out About College Admissions;

The Reality Of Burning Out Before College

Aug 12, 2015 By Samantha Olson

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Common stress producers for teens :

- failing an exam
- physical appearance
- judgment or evaluation by others
- unrealistic classroom demands
- the future
- problems with peers
- problems with a boyfriend or girlfriend
- any situation that threatens self-esteem
- disagreements with teachers, parents or other adults

(Feinstein, *Secrets of the Teenage Brain*, 2004, p.94)

THE ATLANTIC

“High-Stress High School”

What’s the balance between preparing students for college and ensuring they aren’t killing themselves in the process?

ALEXANDRA OSSOLA OCT 9, 2015

The Powerful Impact of Stress

by Victoria Tennant

All children will experience stress, sometimes significant amounts of it, in their lives. Adults ordinarily fail to recognize the incidence and magnitude of stress in the lives of children. For example, studies have shown that

"parents perceive children as having lower levels of stress than children perceive themselves as having."

(Humphrey, *Helping Children Manage Stress*, 1998, p.8) This is confirmed by a nation-wide survey that concludes "parents underestimate how much children worry" (Witkin, *KidStress*, 1999, p.11).
Our complex modern society has greatly increased the amount of stress adults and children are exposed to. Children are experiencing more stress at younger and younger ages.

3 WAYS STRESS NEGATIVELY AFFECTS STUDENTS PERFORMANCE

- **Stress reduces sleep quality** Anxiety and Depression Association of America
- **Stress makes students angrier** The Mayo Clinic reports stress increases feelings of irritability and anger, which increases the likelihood for angry outbursts and social withdrawal.
- **Stress worsens grades** American College Health Association (7) University of Maryland–College Park study

WHO?

- Highly Motivated
- Highly Sensitive
- High Expectations
- Goal Driven

Academic Markers of success:

- GPA
- Test Results
- Schools they get into

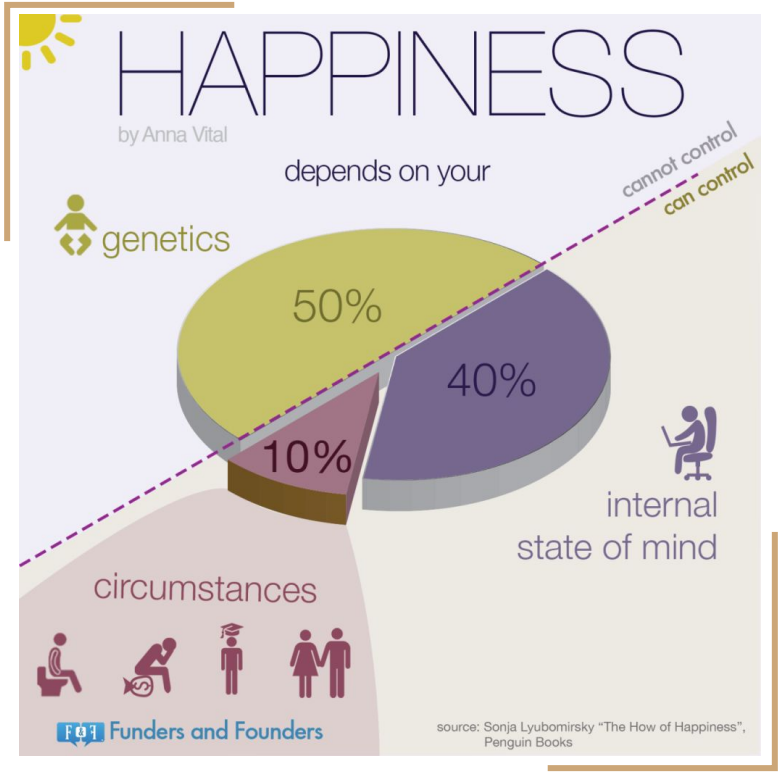
Academic achievements are important and necessary

And. . . so is the blindspot

Preparing them to independently manage their emotions!

Emotional Markers Of Success:

- Resilience
- Grit
- Self-reliance
- Self-compassion
- Self-care
- Self-esteem



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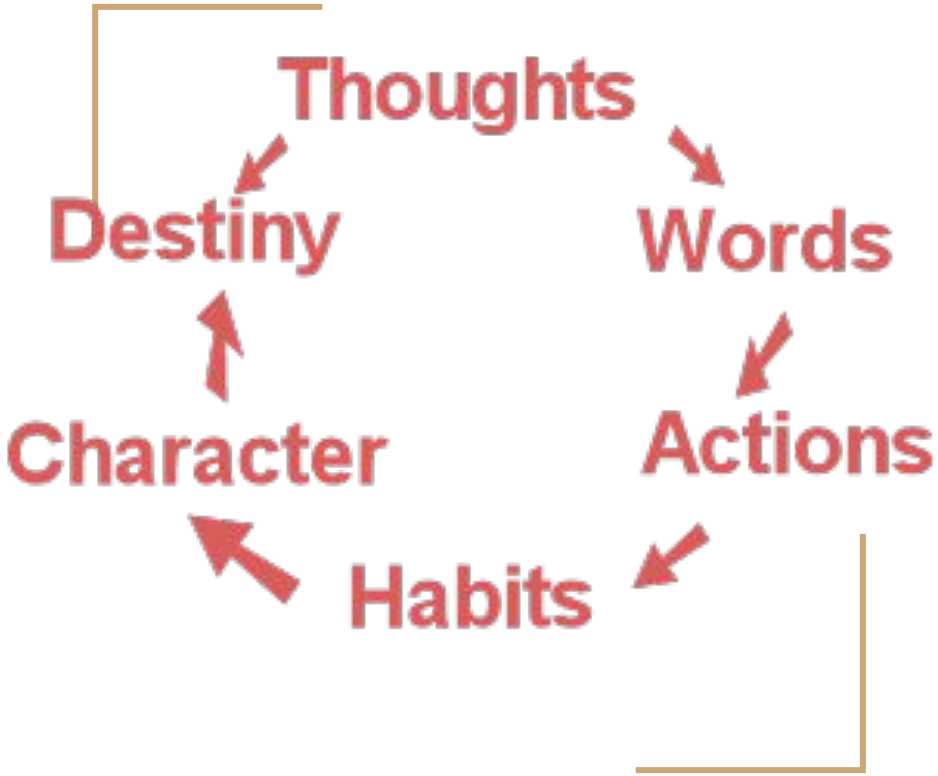

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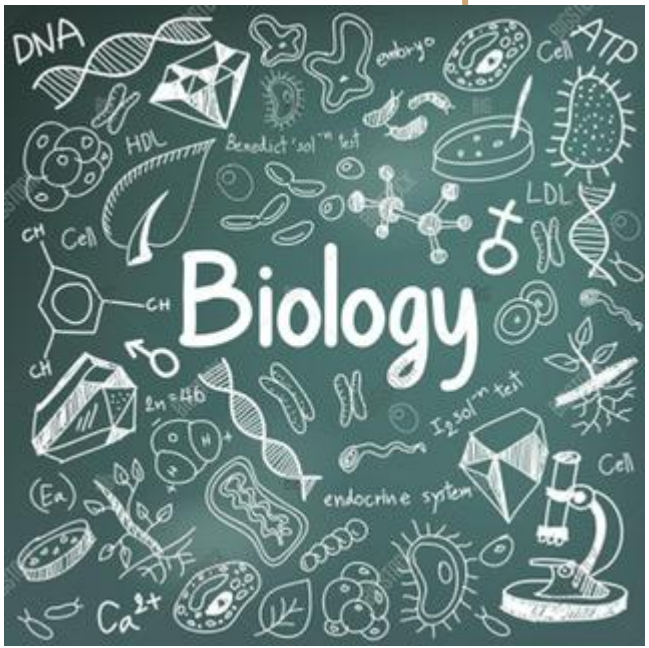
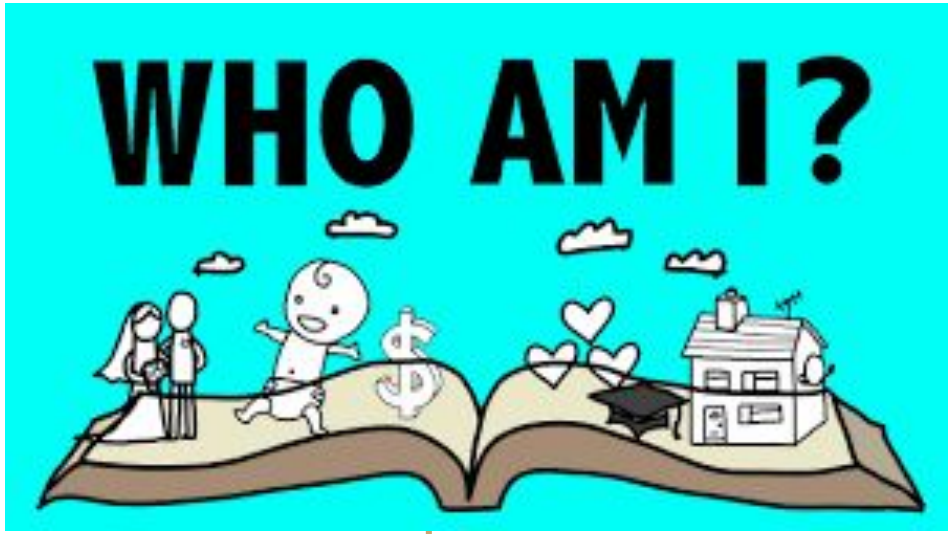
BIOLOGY VS NARRATIVE



VS



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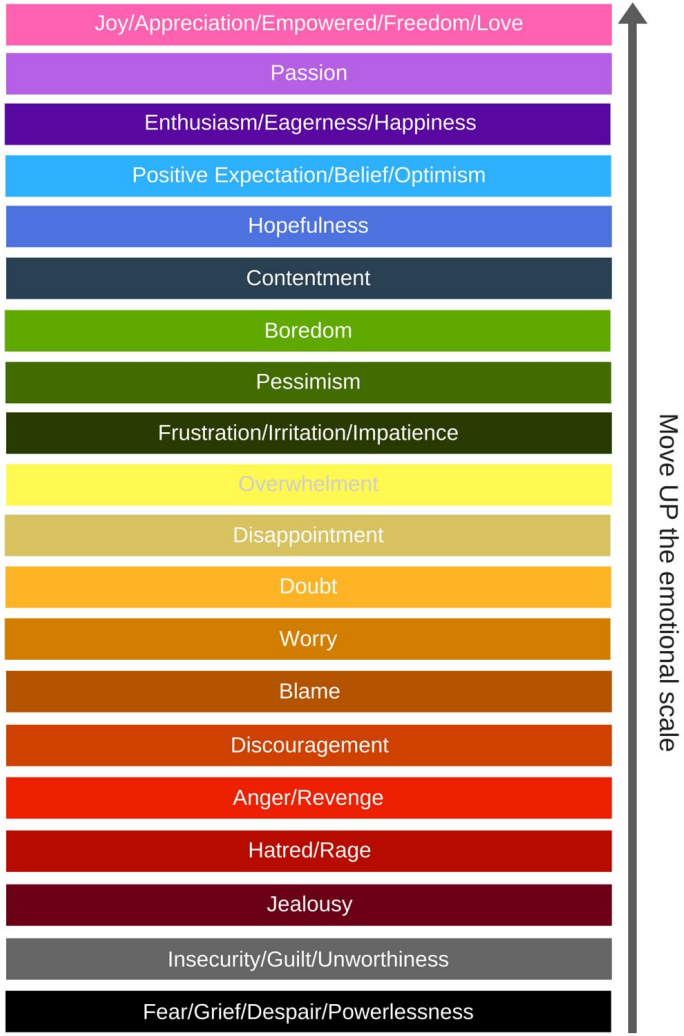

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THE EMOTIONAL SCALE

THOUGHTS		FEELINGS
I LOVE	EXPANSIVE	LOVE/APPRECIATION
I'M FULL		GRATITUDE
I'M ENGAGED	POWERFUL	PASSION
I'M ENERGIZED	AT EASE	ENTHUSIASM
I CAN	HEALTHY	OPTIMISM
I'M OK		CONTENTMENT
MAYBE I CAN		HOPEFUL
I DON'T HURT		NEUTRALITY
I DON'T CARE		BOREDOM/APATHY
I DOUBT		PESSIMISM
I JUDGE		PRIDE / COMPARISON
I WON'T	ILL	ANGER
I NEED	DESPERATE	CRAVING
I CAN'T	UNABLE	DEPRESSION
I DID BAD		GUILT
I AM BAD	CONTRACTED	SHAME

This is a notional scale and a work in progress. It is based on the work of David Hawkins, MD, PhD, Abraham-Hicks, Karla McClaren, Linda Kohanov and my personal experience.

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BELIEFS

Core beliefs: I, me, mine

- Love
- Self-worth
- Feeling Secure
- Feeling Fulfilled

(VOJ) VOICE OF JUDGEMENT

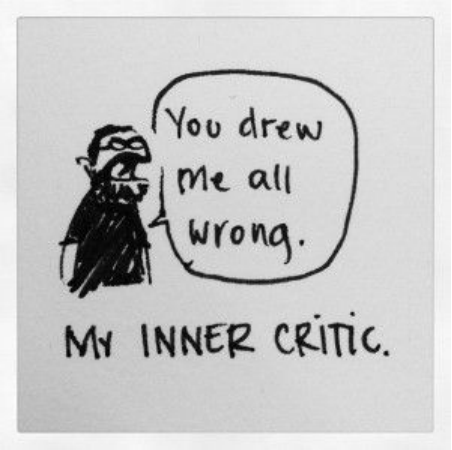
ROOTS:

- **In childhood, it is there initially as a protector, making sure you don't stand out and do fit in.**
- **Raises fear that inevitably thwarts our creativity**

TRAITS:

- **Decision paralysis and risk aversion**
- **Fear of experimentation, discovery and blazing new trails keeping you in your comfort zone.**
- **Feeling put down and held down**

VOJ COMPONENTS



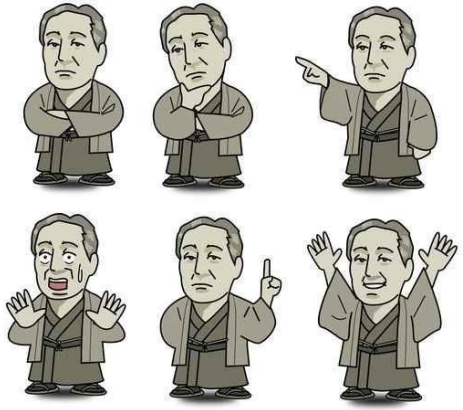
THE INNER CRITIC:

- blames
- shames
- criticizes
- discourages us

THE JUDGE:

- judges

(VOW) VOICE OF WISDOM

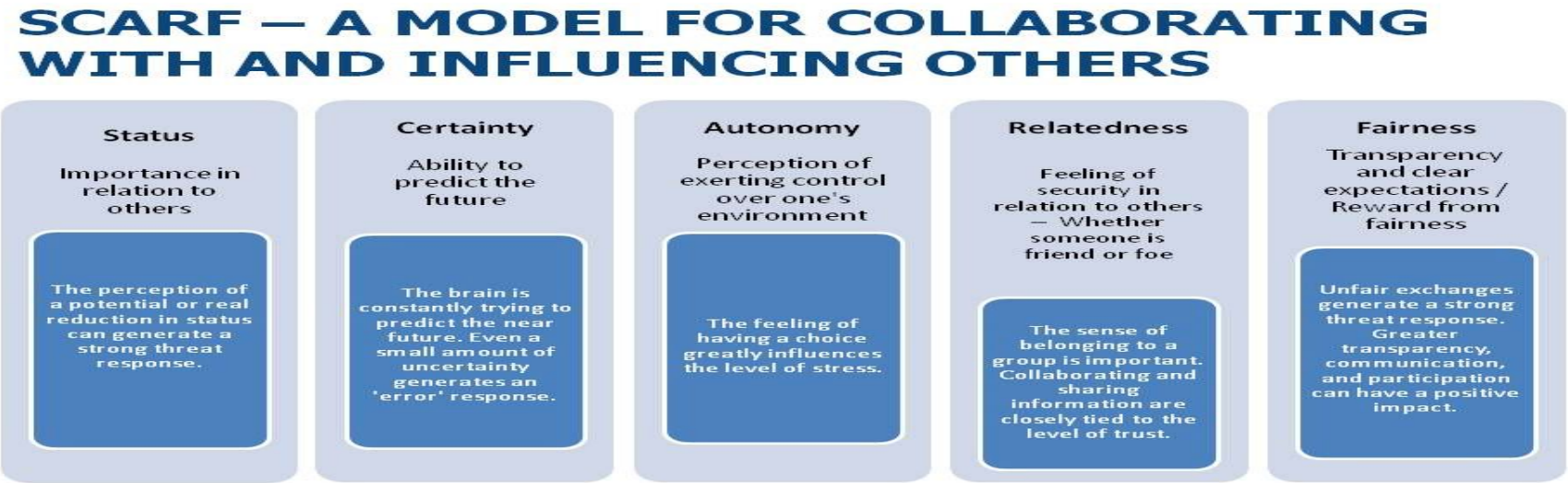


TRAITS:

- curious
- open
- thoughtful
- balanced
- unattached
- patient
- expansive
- CCC calm, cool, collected

THE SCARF MODEL

TICK…


SCARF – A MODEL FOR COLLABORATING WITH AND INFLUENCING OTHERS
Status
Importance in relation to others
The perception of a potential or real reduction in status can generate a strong threat response.
Certainty
Ability to predict the future
The brain is constantly trying to predict the near future. Even a small amount of uncertainty generates an 'error' response.
Autonomy
Perception of exerting control over one's environment
The feeling of having a choice greatly influences the level of stress.
Relatedness
Feeling of security in relation to others – Whether someone is friend or foe
The sense of belonging to a group is important. Collaborating and sharing information are closely tied to the level of trust.
Fairness
Transparency and clear expectations / Reward from fairness
Unfair exchanges generate a strong threat response. Greater transparency, communication, and participation can have a positive impact.

PLAY WITH YOUR SCARF!

- Tune into an interaction where you experienced negative emotion(s)
- Describe the interaction with as much detail as possible in 2 minutes
- Identify what SCARF triggers were in play
- Repeat using an example where someone else experienced a negative emotion(s)
- Repeat using an example where you experienced positive emotion(s)

THE VOICE

There is a voice inside of you
That whispers all day long,
"I feel that this is right for me,
I know that *this* is wrong."
No teacher, preacher, parent, friend
Or wise man can decide
What's right for you—just listen to
The voice that speaks inside.

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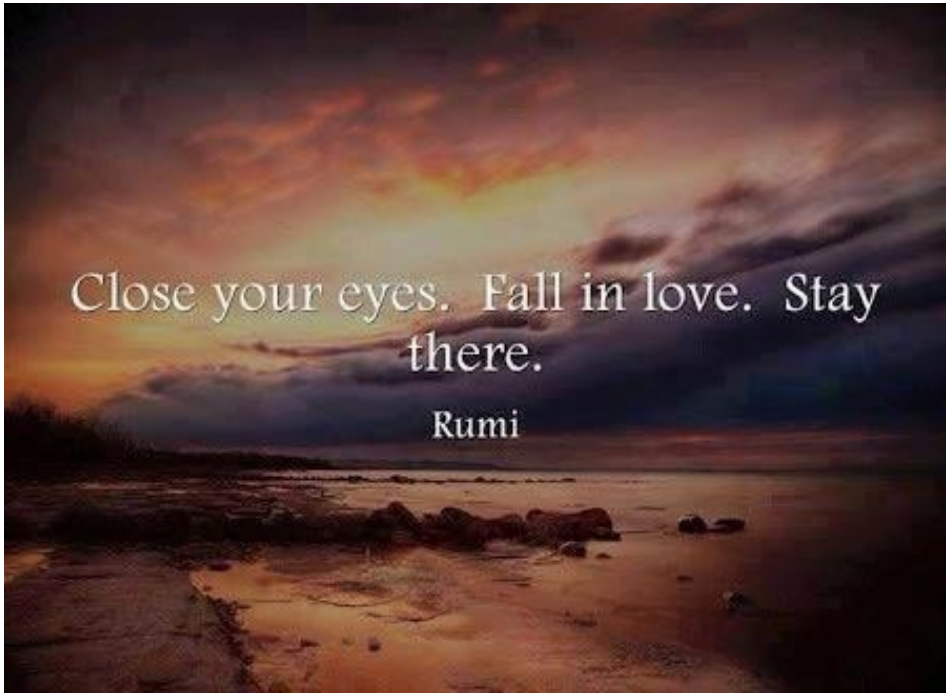
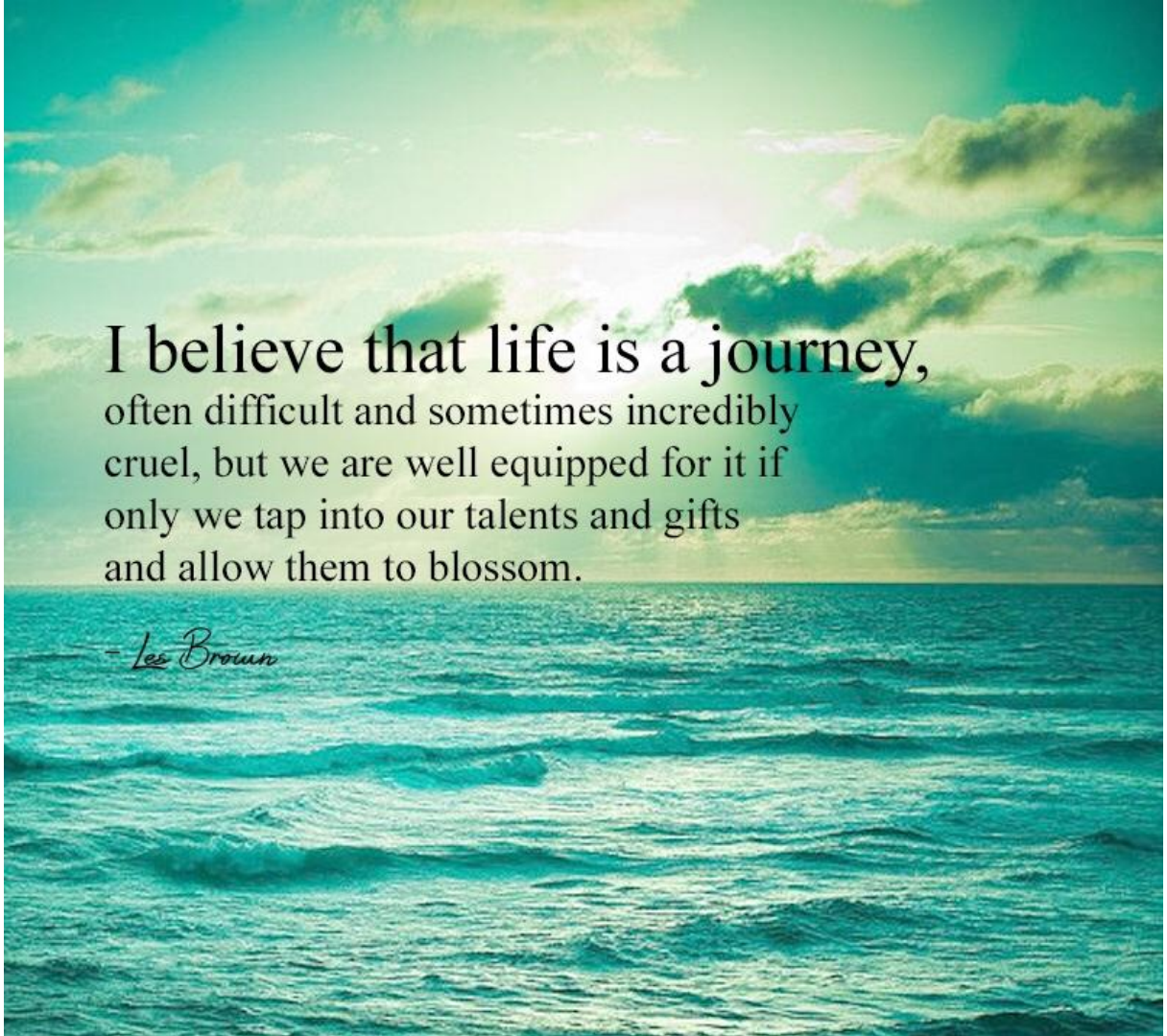
Is there a more helpless feeling than not knowing how to support your child while they struggle?

Make sure they are Equipped For The Journey!

Resource Page





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